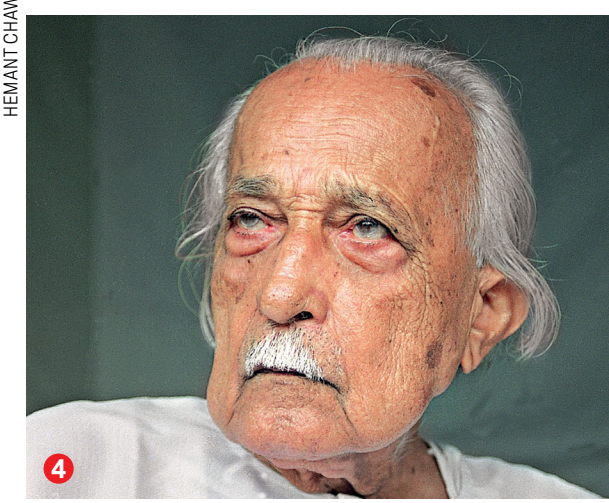


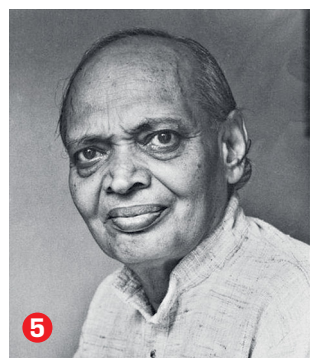


HEMANT CHAWLA



YASBANT NEGI







RAWAL SHAILESH

1. **Arun Kolatkar** *(Marathi)*
2. **Girish Karnad** *(Kannada)*
3. **Mahashweta Devi** *(Bangla)*
4. **Shivarama Karanth** *(Kannada)*
5. **Suresh Joshi** *(Gujarati)*
6. **Bhupen Khakhar** *(Gujarati)*

The tension that once prevailed in the relation of Sanskrit and Prakrit or Desi languages and Persian exists now between Indian languages and English. It is not sufficient to note that Chitre and Kolatkar were bilingual poets. Chitre was a painter and film-maker. Kolatkar, too, was a painter and a graphic artist. Chitre called his tryst with several languages and forms of creativity as "living a life on a bridge", trying to connect different worlds. "I have been working in a haunted workshop rattled and shaken by the spirits of other literatures unknown to my ancestors. In fact, unknown spirits claim to be my literary ancestors clamouring for recognition. Europe has already haunted my house. A larger Indian tradition besieges it too...this is my predicament as a writer. I have to build a bridge within myself between India and Europe, or else I become a fragmented person." (*The Bombay Literary Review*, 1989-I). Kolatkar's Marathi poems used surrealism and imagism very effectively. His poem *Takta*, based on the Marathi alphabet, strikes one as characteristically unique. In sharp contrast to this, the god Khandoba and different deities and myths known in every household of Maharashtra also find place in his poems, like in 'Chaitanya': "*Come off it/ Said Chaitanya to a stone/ in stone language/ Wipe the red paint off your face/ I don't think the colour suits you/ I mean what's wrong/ with being just a plain stone/ I'll still bring you flowers/ You like the flowers of Zendu/ don't you/ I like them too/ scratch a rock/ and a legend springs.*" The heart of the literary art of Chitre and Kolatkar lay in inventing style and expression where their predecessors thought literature had reached its limits.

The two Gujarati writers who must be mentioned are Suresh Joshi and Bhupen Khakhar. Both were exiles of